

Introduce, then invite

A plan for Arterial's fall fundraising campaign on social media,
and where we would **love your thinking**.

Arterial.org · 501(c)(3)

Fall campaign

For discussion with Julie Norris

WHERE WE ARE STARTING

Most people have never heard of Arterial

WHAT PEOPLE KNOW

They know **Not Real Art**. Or they know **Artsville USA**. They follow one of them, they like the work, and that is where it ends.

WHAT THEY DO NOT KNOW

Arterial is the non-profit behind them. It is the registered 501(c)(3) that holds Not Real Art, Artsville USA, Classic Black and the rest.

You cannot ask someone to support an organisation they have not met. So the campaign's first job is not fundraising. It is **introducing the family**.

THE TOOL, IN ONE SLIDE

What we are using to do it

We have built a piece of software called **PolyWiz**. You give it one thing to work from, either a web page or a PDF, and it writes **months of social media posts** from it and schedules them out over time.

IT WRITES IN THE BRAND'S VOICE

Each organisation has its own voice on file, so the posts sound like Arterial rather than like software.

IT POSTS EVERYWHERE AT ONCE

Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn, Pinterest and more, each written the way that platform expects.

A PERSON APPROVES EVERYTHING

Nothing publishes on its own. Every post is reviewed and edited before it goes anywhere.

The point is not volume for its own sake. It is that a small team can keep up a steady, consistent presence for three months without it becoming somebody's second job.

THE APPROACH

Introduce, amplify, then invite

FIRST

Introduce

Who Arterial is, what it holds, the people and the work behind it. No mention of money at all.

THEN

Amplify

Ask people to share it and tell someone who would care. Spreading the word counts as real support, not as a consolation prize.

THEN

Invite

Ask for support directly and warmly, always tied to what a gift actually pays for.

What we are deliberately **not** doing: countdowns, last chances, "we are falling short", or any of the pressure tactics that make people feel handled.

THE SHAPE OF IT

Two campaigns, three months

MONTH 1

Meet Arterial

A month of posts that only introduce. Who Arterial is, what sits under it, the people, the programmes, the work that already exists.

Posted often, so the picture builds up.

Nothing is asked for.

MONTHS 2 AND 3

The fall campaign

Now the campaign itself. Why this work matters, help us spread the word, and a warm, direct invitation to give.

By this point the audience knows who is asking, which is the whole reason for month one.

The ask has earned its context.

Month one keeps working after it ends. Those posts do not expire, and they are still introducing Arterial to new people while the campaign runs.

What a warm ask sounds like

YES

"Arterial is making a documentary about an art movement nobody has put on screen. You can help fund it."

"The campaign runs through December 15."

"Worth backing if you care about this."

NO

"Only 6 days left."

"We are falling short of our goal."

"Without you, this ends."

"Last chance to make a difference."

Direct is fine. **Pressure is not.** This is the line we would most like your read on, because you have watched far more of these run than we have.

THE GROWTH IDEA

Collaborator posts put us in front of new people

On Instagram, two accounts can **share a single post**. It appears on both feeds, and both audiences see it. One post, two audiences, no advertising spend.

THE EASY HALF

Arterial's own family. Not Real Art and Artsville USA already have followings, and a campaign post can go out on those feeds too.

THE BIGGER PRIZE

Collaborators from outside the family. Artists, arts organisations, aligned non-profits. Each one puts the campaign in front of an audience that has never heard of Arterial, and each one arrives as a recommendation rather than an advert.

This is **your question far more than ours**. Who should those partners be? That is a fundraising and relationships question, and it is where outside judgement is worth more than any software.

WHERE WE WOULD LOVE YOUR INPUT

Four things we are unsure about

1. Is a month of pure introduction before any ask the right balance, or too long a wait?
2. Is our line on warm-but-never-pressured right, or are we leaving money on the table?
3. Which outside partners should we be approaching for shared posts?
4. What do you normally see work in a fall campaign that we have not mentioned at all?

Related reading in this archive: [Dollar for the Arts](#), a small-donation front end for the same campaign, and [Arterial's owned platform](#).

What we are asking for

A working session with you, separate from this one, to think through **where else this approach could be used** and to help us **shape the two campaign styles we are building**: the introduction campaign, and the fundraising campaign.

Both are being built now, so this is a good moment to influence them.
Nothing here is finished.

Introduce first

Invite warmly

Bring in partners